

Business Analysis Practitioner Course

The Rationale for Business Analysis

- Explain the role of the BA throughout the business change lifecycle
- Understand the scope of the BA role within the context of the range of analysis activities: strategic analysis and definition, business analysis, and IT systems analysis
- Identify three competency areas for a BA: personal qualities, business knowledge, and professional techniques

Understanding the Strategic Context

- Apply the MOST technique to analyze the internal environment of an organization
- Apply the resource audit technique to analyze the internal environment of an organization.
- Apply the PESTLE technique to analyze the external environment of an organization
- Apply Porter's Five Forces technique to analyze the external environment of an organization
- Explain the purpose of a SWOT analysis
- Identify strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats for a given scenario
- Define and explain the relationship between Critical Success Factor, Key Performance Indicator, and Performance Targets.
- Define the elements of the balanced business scorecard and describe how it may be used to identify Critical Success Factors and Key Performance Indicators

Understanding the Current Situation

- Identify the generic stakeholder categories defined in the stakeholder wheel
- Identify relevant investigation techniques for a given scenario
- Explain the rationale for taking a holistic view when investigating a business situation
- Interpret the business situation represented in rich pictures, mind maps, and fishbone diagrams

Stakeholder Analysis and Management

- In a given scenario, describe stakeholders in terms of their power/influence and level of interest
- Select an appropriate stakeholder management strategy based on the position on the Power/Interest Grid
- Apply the CATWOE technique to explore stakeholder business perspectives.
- Explain different stakeholder business perspectives based on elements of CATWOE to identify similarities and differences in their worldviews

Analyzing and Modeling Business Activities

- Explain the rationale for building conceptual models of a business situation
- Understand how to construct a conceptual business activity model based on a given scenario
- Understand how the five types of high-level activity within a business activity model (and the dependencies between them) represent a stakeholder's business perspective
- Explain the role of the planning activities in determining performance targets for a business system represented in the business activity model

- Explain the role of the enabling activities, in acquiring and replenishing resources for a business system represented in the business activity model
- Explain the role of the activities in conducting the work of the transformation, as defined in the stakeholder's CATWOE
- Explain the role of monitoring and control activities, in regulating a business system represented in the business activity model
- Explain the three types of business events
- In a given business activity model, identify the business events that will be handled by particular business activity
- Explain the rationale for the consensus business activity model

Identifying Potential Solutions

- In a given business scenario, distinguish between the different categories of business rules
- Describe the process for carrying out gap analysis by comparing the conceptual business activity model and existing business situation
- Define the components of a new business model

Building the Business Case

- Explain the rationale for the development of a business case.
- Describe the contents of a business case
- Interpret a scenario to identify tangible and intangible costs and benefits, risks, and impacts
- Understand the rationale for the development of the financial case and the appraisal techniques
- Explain where a business case sits within the business change lifecycle and the rationale for reviewing it at each stage